Some Tips on using Tableau And Thoughts on Approaches to Performance Measurement

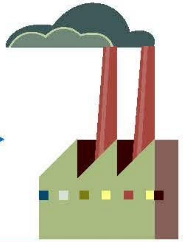
Skip Krueger, PhD

July 17, 2026

Where it all started

The Production Process and Performance Measures

Inputs = Raw materials used in the manufacturing process. Simplified as **Total Expenditures**.



Construction Stage.
(The black box.)

Output = Number of units of the manufactured product that are made/delivered.

Quality = how well the product is constructed. Measuring quality is difficult. ("Outcomes" and "Effectiveness" are synonyms for "Quality".)

Efficiency = How inexpensively the product manufactured. (**Cost per unit produced** = Expenditures/# of units produced)

The Market

***Demand** = All potential purchasers of your product*

The "Logic Model" in Our World

Input

Assumption 1:
This much money will pay for this much Activity.

Activities

Assumption 2:
This much activity will give this many Outputs.

Output

Assumption 3:
This many Outputs will lead to this change in society (measured as Outcomes/ Effectiveness/Quality)

Outcome

The "logic" of the Logic Model is a set of assumptions.

The assumptions may or may not be right for your jurisdiction at that point in time.

- Even if true in the research literature generally.

So, Performance Measurement has two jobs:

1. Check those assumptions.
2. Track that the organization is meeting it's promised performance goals.

Developing the Logic: Work the logic model backwards

1. What social impact do we want?
2. What is the best way to get to that social impact?
3. What activities will give us those outputs?
4. What is the best way to organize to implement those activities and how much will it cost?

Outcomes
↓
Outputs
↓
Activities
↓
Inputs

Decision-Driven Analytics

The new Nerd Cool

1. **Trend: Outcomes (back) in focus**
   - This trend is driving a greater focus on impacts to communities
   - Asking the HARDEST question: What value added is Performance Measurement providing?

2. **Cost vs Quality:**
   - In addition to focusing on what the community needs/wants, it helps sharpen the discussion of the trade-off between price (efficiency) and quality (outcome/effectiveness).
   - Do ALL programs need to be Lexus-level? Is it ok to fund some programs as Hondas?

3. **Needs of the Decisions steer the boat**
   - Turns the conversation from data-driven decisions and to ways in which data analytics can help (but not be the sole issue) with difficult decisions
     - Maybe especially at the level of policy, strategic planning, budgets

OK, let's do this

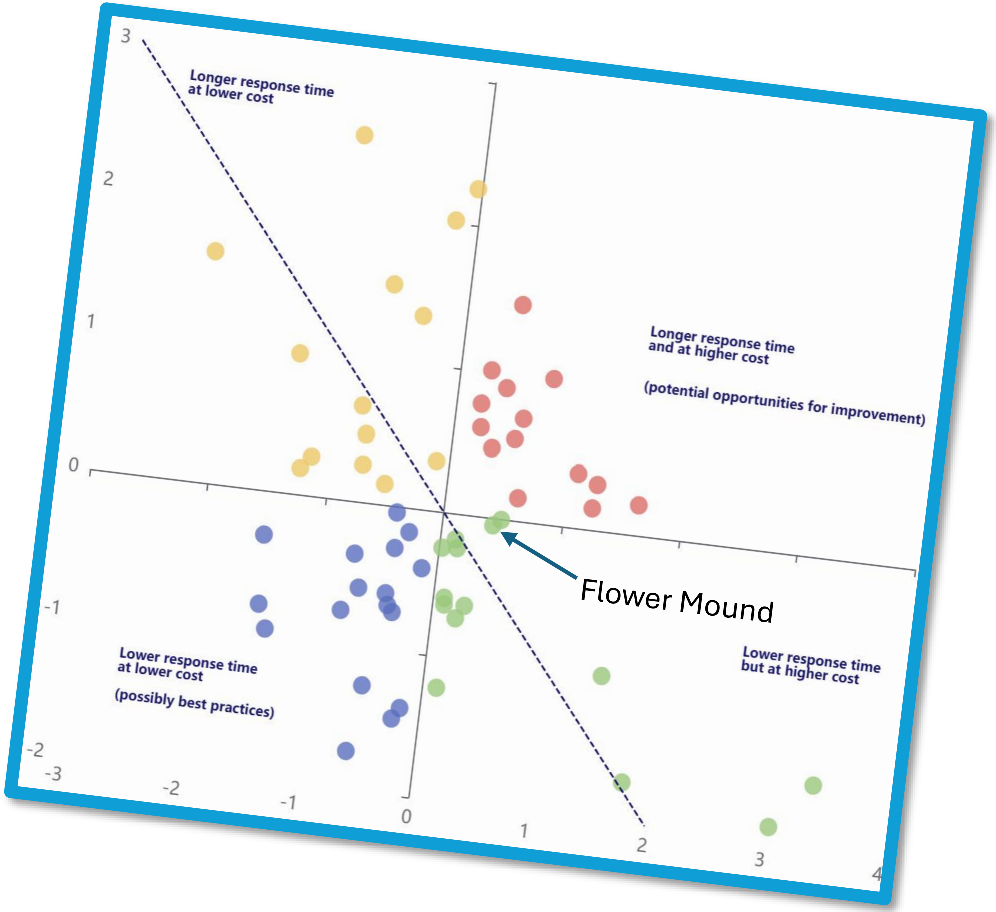
Go to:

github.com/skipkrueger

github.com/skipkrueger

Links to some helpful information

1. Github dataset
2. Emojis
3. Unicode Symbols
4. HTML Color Codes
5. Data Visualization for Readers experiencing Color Blindness
6. Comparative Outcomes



Things to consider and opportunities to seek

Big Picture:

1. Audience – policy vs mgmt, senior mgmt vs dept staff
2. Aggregations – time, type, teams
3. Outputs vs Outcomes – can you find at least short-term outcomes to quantify quality and does it do better than bars of soap?
4. Set up Fiscal Years – helps keep outputs/outcomes connected to budget (inputs)

Visualizations:

1. Symbols –help keep it simple
2. Trends – direction over time is key
3. Filters – can be so helpful
4. Tool tips – unique information
5. Labels – if it's not necessary, it goes

Decision-Driven Analytics:

What **decisions** do you want the data to help with?

- Let this guide your choices

Please stay in touch

1. **Email:**
   - Skip@KruegerConsulting.io
2. **Text:**
   - 206-486-5749
3. **LinkedIn:**
   - https://www.linkedin.com/in/skip-krueger-39a3b9153/

vCard:

Thanks for letting me join you today!